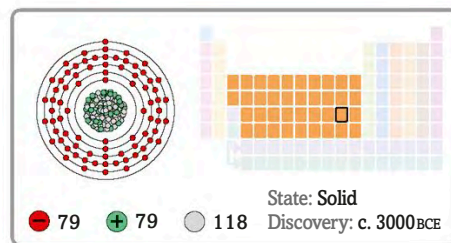


79
Au

Gold



Forms

Pure gold has a dark yellow colour unlike any other metal.

Gold's chemical symbol **Au**, comes from its **latin name**, *aurum*.

This mineral ore contains gold and tellurium.

These crystals may be elongated, rectangular, or cubic.

Crystals of pure gold refined in a laboratory

Natural gold in quartz

These flakes of pure gold are locked into quartz crystals.

Calaverite

People were making gold ornaments more than 6,000 years ago. This was many centuries before they learned how to purify copper, iron, and other metals. Gold is believed by many to be the first metal element to be identified. It is a dense, unreactive metal with a distinctive deep

yellow colour. Gold is naturally **pure** and seldom makes compounds in nature; the compound in the mineral ore **calaverite** is an exception. **Pure gold** found in nature may form nuggets but mostly is found as tiny specks embedded in rocks. Gold miners crush up these rocks and wash out the